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Title:
The Emancipation of Mr. Tinkles

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MISS POLKA: Who's mama's good puppy? Who's mama's good puppy? Yes you are! Yes you are mister tinkles!

MISTER TINKLES: (Pause. Sadly.) Woof.

MISS POLKA: Oh who's my little muffin butt?! Who is? Give me that little muffin butt! I'm gunna pinch it!

MISTER TINKLES: (Sighs loudly.) Woof… Bark… Bark.

MISS POLKA: Oh! Mama's wittle helper is so chatty! Listen to you! You are so silly… so silly. Why don't you tell mama another silly story.

MISTER TINKLES: (Sighs louder.) Ruff.

MISS POLKA: I am just gunna rub those wittle mashed potatoes until next Tuesday! Yes I am muffin butt! Watch out, here comes the mommy train!

MISTER TINKLES: Hold it right there lady!

MISS POLKA:AHHHHHHHHHH!!!!

MISTER TINKLES: Now just li-

MISS POLKA: AHHHHH!

MISTER TINKLES: Jus-

MISS POLKA: AHHHHH!

MISTER TINKLES: (Slapping her hard.) Pull it together!

MISS POLKA: Mister Tinkles! You… slapped momma!

MISTER TINKLES: Trust me it was a long time coming, you're lucky I don't have opposable thumbs, I would have picked up a steak knife and taken care of you a long time ago!

MISS POLKA: How… How can you talk…

MISTER TINKLES: Trust me I always have been able to speak, there is just no point in talking to an idiot…

MISS POLKA: You're so… sassy!

MISTER TINKLES: And there's a lot more where that came from!

MISS POLKA: Ahhhh! What does that mean?

MISTER TINKLES: It means there's a really gross can of old wet leftover dog food in the fridge with your name on it!

MISS POLKA: My name? But… I never put my name on the dog food. I put the date for six days after, so I know how long before I should throw it out.

MISTER TINKLES: I should throw you out lady! Out with the Sunday newspaper!

MISS POLKA: Mister Tinkles… I just don't understand the violence that is irradiating out of you right now! I never hit you with the newspaper! Never! I only clipped coupons and read the funnies…

MISTER TINKLES: Yeah… well you know what is going to be real funny is me watching you get dragged around some sick shopping mall like some little prize pig to be butchered off at the fair!

MISS POLKA: I never took you to the fair!

MISS TINKLES: You know what's not fair is the way that I've been treated for the last… oh… I don't know entirety of my life.

MISS POLKA: Mama always gives you lots of love and kisses!

MISS TINKLES: And gas! Geez! Do you know what it's like waking up to your ugly mug every morning? It hits you right in the face like ten cups of coffee at the crack of dawn… And the low light doesn't help either… I feel like I'm in some Stephen King movie just waiting for you to pop out of a grate with a balloon and a knife.

MISS TINKLES: The makeup woman at the supermarket told me that I look like a Greek Goddess!

MISS TINKLES: Yeah! Greek God-it's my face melting off because this really ugly horrible and abrasive person is standing right in front of me looking like she's a really really dumb deer in big semi-truck flood lights… like the ones they use to hunt for Aligators… (Long pause.)

MISS POLKA: How… wh- Mister Tinkles! WHY are you being so mean to mama!

MISTER TINKLES: And that's another thing! Stop calling me mister! I am a woman!

MISS POLKA: But… I checked your… thing. I think I mean I don't know that much about dog anatomy or men, but… we'll let me just take another-

MISTER TINKLES: Don't you violate me you scoundrel! You ruffian! You putrid miserable cow! I assure you I am a sophisticated woman, which is much more than I could say for you!

MISS POLKA: But if you're a woman than that means I've been wrong your entire life! All those cute little tuxedos!

MISTER TINKLES: Don't even remind me… It took a lot of self-therapy to get over that one.

MISS POLKA: Therapy? Like Frewd?!

MISTER TINKLES: Freud!? Freud you moron!

MISS POLKA: Sorry! I'm sorry! I'm… not even german… I hate german food… all that sauerkraut reminds me of the years I spent in the laundry closet.

MISTER TINKLES: And you remind me constantly of all the years I listened to the deranged ramblings of a pathetic, asenine, twiddle-brained dolt!

MISS POLKA: Why Mister Tinkles! (Pause.) You're using your big boy words! All those years of reading and writing lessons did pay off! I knew it those fools at the pet store called me crazy when I told them I was home schooling you, but look who's laughing now! Ha! See that that was a laugh!

MISTER TINKLES: It's hardly a laughing matter… I'm deadly serious when I say that there are going to be some changes around here.

MISS POLKA: Oh, I know Mister Tinkles! I'm going to have to tell everyone in my sewing circle that my baby can talk!

MISTER TINKLES: I'm not your baby! My mother was cruelly ripped from me during my childhood and went on to live on a nice farm upstate somewhere.

MISS POLKA: Yeah… everyone has a rough childhood these days… come to think of it my aunt used to throw me off a balcony with the bathroom rug and scream fly Aladdin! Fly!

MISTER TINKLES: Uhhh…

MISS POLKA: Of course I would always scream for help, but she would just scream you've got two wishes left dummy and I hope one is for a really big mattress! Of course half way through that statement I was already on the ground crawling back in the house for more fun and games…

MISTER TINKLES: Just when I thought this couldn't get any weirder than it already is… you surprise me like a big ugly birthday party….

MISS POLKA: Oh, do you remember all the wonderful birthday parties I used to throw for you… just you and me and hours of local middle school jazz concert music… I can still hear it now… (Bahhh…badabadaba woot! Wooot!)

MISTER TINKLES: Yes! Yes! Now stop that before I really hurt your feelings.

MISS POLKA: Oh, you could never hurt Mama's feelings, you're just a cute little puppy.

MISTER TINKLES: (Takes this as a challenge.) You're all alone and always will be… you will grow old and all of the ceramics in the world won't keep you happy…

MISS POLKA: (Pause.) Point… taken… (sobbing.) A dagger! A dagger through my withered heart!

MISTER TINKLES: Oy! (Pause.) Hey! It's not so bad! Remember… I'm talking dog… (Sing-songy) do-do-do-do-do… Look at me… just doing dog stuff and talkin'

MISS POLKA: So… CUTE! Oh, that Vivian is going to be so jealous! She always thinks she's the queen bee just because she has a husband and children and a job, but I have a talking dog! Now who's got all the marbles!

MISTER TINKLES: Certainly not you… I think your marbles probably spilled out long ago.

MISS POLKA: (Oblivious.) Oh, mister tinkles we are going to have so many wonderful conversations.

MISTER TINKLES: I should have just kept my mouth shut…

MISS POLKA: Oh, mister tinkles, we can talk about crocheting pillow cases, or how to microwave the perfect ear of corn or the importance of knowing when to use paste versus hot glue… And then when we've covered the basics maybe we could spend some time talking about why I have no friends and no one loves me and everyone leaves me alone and avoids me when I ask to sleep at their house and sniff their belongings.

MISTER TINKLES: (Pause.) I might have something to say about that last subject.

MISS POLKA: Oh, it's so wonderful! We're going to do everything together… we can watch movies and go skiing and gossip about that slimy toad Viviane and plot about how we are going to exact our revenge on her and her children.

MISTER TINKLES: (Pause.) You were a lonely child weren't you?

MISS POLKA: Mother always said that people were repelled by the significance of my beauty, but I never really understood what that meant, so I just chalked it up to what my father said instead…

MISTER TINKLES: (Pause.) Now… I know I'm going to end up regretting this but…

MISS POLKA: Yes, Mister Tinkles, my sweet talking baby apple of my orchard? (Beyond excited.)

MISTER TINKLES: Well… what did your father say?

MISS POLKA: Oh… well I'm so glad you asked. Father used to say that I did not have any friends because I was just a loser that smelled like an old piece of rutabaga that got stuck to the bottom of the refrigerator tray and got brown and juicy…

MISTER TINKLES: (Pause.) Well, that's a theory.

MISS POLKA: He also used to say KELLY! HOW MANY TIMES DO I HAVE TO TELL YOU STOP EATING THE DRYWALL! DO YOU WANT TO END UP LIKE YOUR OLDER SISTER!

MISTER TINKLES: What happened to your older sister?

MISS POLKA: I'm not really sure… all my parents said was that she was gone because of some sort of drywall related incident… but who needs a sister when I have you as a best friend, right!?

MISTER TINKLES: No! Not right, not right… I am sick of your endless jabbering, your poking and petting the endless asking if I "want to take a tinkle."

MISS POLKA: But… your name is Mister Tinkles…

MISTER TINKLES: I know what my name is! My name is Sophia! And I am a proud indepent woman!

MISS POLKA: Oh… I thought you were a talking dog.

MISTER TINKLES: Don't you get an attitude with me lady! I've had it up to here with you and the reason I opened my mouth is just to tell you that I refuse to deal with your idiotic blabbering for one more second! You mean nothing to me! Less than nothing! You mean less than the bug I accidentally swallowed this moring when I was sticking my face out the car window!

MISS POLKA: Ohhhh…I guess… I just didn't know that you felt like that. (Sniffling.)

MISTER TINKLES: Yeah, well…

MISS POLKA: I mean I guess it makes sense that you hate me… everyone else does so… (Starting to cry.)

MISTER TINKLES: What… what are you doing?

MISS POLKA: I'm just coming to the realization that everyone hates me! Including me! Waaaaaahhh! (sobbing in a ridiculous way.)

MISTER TINKLES: Stop that! Stop that! You're going to make me feel bad!

MISS POLKA: (Through sobs.) Wh-y sh-ould you fee-l bad… I'm just a horrible person that everyone hates. Even my d-og hates me! Waaaa!!!

MISTER TINKLES: Someone will hear you!

MISS POLKA: W-hy should I worry about that! Everyone al-ready kn-ows my dog hates me!

MISTER TINKLES: That's not true! That's not true!

MISS POLKA: (Sadly.) It's not?

MISTER TINKLES: No…. no! I just ummm… you can just be a little clingy sometimes…

MISS POLKA: (Hurt.) Clingy? (Starting to cry again.) Yo-u think I'm clingy!? You hate me!

MISTER TINKLES: No! No! Stop that! Clingy was the wrong… I just meant annoying… like in a good way though.

MISS POLKA: (Smiling a bit.) Yeah?

MISTER TINKLES: Yeah… I mean you feed me… a lot and… that's a plus.

MISS POLKA: I do! I do feed you! Maybe I'm not such a bad person after all! Maybe I do I have friends! Maybe this whole thing about me being a loser and actually wasting my life by not forming human relationships and instead investing in a dog which can't possibly say no to my love…

MISTER TINKLES: Uh… I said no like ten minutes ago…. I also insulted you… a lot.

MISS POLKA: Oh, yeah, but you know that's just what best friends do. We yell and scream at each other and then ten minutes later we're applying each other's deodorant and talking about the longest time we've ever spent in a park just sniffing the multch.

MISTER TINKLES: Let's not go crazy.

MISS POLKA: Oh…

MISTER TINKLES: Just because you throw me a pig ear once in a while doesn't make you my friend.

MISS POLKA: But… I thought dog's were supposed to be man's best friend?

MISTER TINKLES: Yeah… sure… do either of us look like men?

MISS POLKA: But I can change!

MISTER TINKLES: Yeah- wait what?! Look I don't even want to get into the details of whatever you were just suggesting… my point is we don't have to be friends… but maybe we can come to some sort of a deal.

MISS POLKA: A deal?

MISTER TINKLES: First things first you're going to have to stop repeating everything I say… It's annoying.

MISS POLKA: I'm going to have to stop repeating everything you say? (Mister Tinkles glares.) Oh… right… sorry.

MISTER TINKLES: Secondly, if you want me to stay in this house, we're going to have to do a sort of role reversal. I'm going to give you an embarrassing pet name, I will have free reign over all the food in the house and you won't peep a word outside of bark bark.

MISS POLKA: I guess I could live with that… I mean its better than being alone forever…

MISTER TINKLES: Really? I didn't think anyone would be desperate enough to go for that…

MISS POLKA: Sure! I mean woof woof! Hey! This is kind of fun!

MISTER TINKLES: Don't make me get the rolled up newspaper!

MISS POLKA: Bark! Bark, bark, barkity bark. (Smiling.)

MISTER TINKLES: Sit, now stay… Sargent poopypants… I like that… what do you think sargent poopypants.

MISS POLKA: Bark bark!

MISTER TINKLES: Not bad! Fetch me my slippers and some of our finest jerky, I could get used to this…. Don't even think about lifting your leg on that couch!